

COP928 - Sample Exam Questions

Please read the following information carefully before attempting the sample questions.

Important Notes

- The actual final exam will be out of 100 marks.
- The sample questions provided are intended to give you 2–3 examples from each chapter to help you become familiar with the style and type of questions.
- The mark allocation in this sample does not reflect the exact weighting in the actual exam and may vary between chapters.
- If a word limit is specified, please ensure that you do not exceed it.

Answering the Questions (Final Exam)

- In the actual exam, for each question, dedicated space will be provided directly underneath the question for you to write your answer.
- You are expected to use this space to present your response clearly and concisely.

Question 1. (Codes of conduct and ethics)

An employee believes their company is acting unethically but is unsure what to do.

Outline two steps the employee should take before considering public whistleblowing.

[6 marks]

Answer

Talk about it within the team/organisation: Raise the issue, get allies, be factual, and suggest solutions if possible. *(3 marks)*

Use company reporting procedures: If informal discussion is not enough, use formal internal reporting processes. *(3 marks)*

Question 2. (Codes of conduct and ethics)

A company is deciding whether to release a new app quickly to beat competitors, even though they know it may have some security risks.

Using a consequentialist ethical approach, explain what the company should do.

[6 marks]

Answer

Consequentialist ethics Focuses on outcomes and choosing the action that leads to the best overall result. *(1 mark)*

The company should consider the impact on all stakeholders. Releasing the app may benefit the company (profit, competition) but could harm users (security risks).

Therefore, the company should delay the release and fix the issues to achieve better overall outcomes. *(5 marks)*

Question 3. (Data Privacy)

A user contacts a company and asks for all their personal data to be deleted.

Based on UK GDPR, should the company accept this request? Justify your answer.

[5 marks]

Answer

Yes, the company may accept the request *(2 marks)*:

Under UK GDPR, individuals can request deletion of their personal data.

Justification *(3 marks)*:

The request should be accepted if the data is no longer needed and there is no valid reason to keep it (e.g. legal obligation or legitimate purpose).

Question 4. (Data Privacy)

A social media company collects large amounts of user data, including location, device information, and browsing behaviour. Some of this data is shared with third-party companies, and users are not fully aware of how their data is used.

Identify and explain two data privacy issues in this scenario and discuss their potential impact. **[8 marks]**

Answer

One issue is **managing third-party data risks**, as the company shares user data with external organisations. This increases the risk of unauthorised access or misuse and reduces control over personal data. *(4 marks)*

Another issue is **trust between customers and businesses**. Since users are not fully aware of how their data is used, this can reduce trust and may make users less willing to share their data, potentially damaging the company's reputation. *(4 marks)*

Question 5. (Data Privacy)

A company operating across several EU countries claims that it has to deal with multiple data protection authorities in different countries.

Is this consistent with GDPR? Explain your answer. **[4 marks]**

Answer

No, this is not consistent with GDPR (*2 marks*). Under GDPR, a company mainly deals with one data protection authority, usually in the country where its main establishment is located (*2 marks*).

Question 6. (Information Governance)

Explain the difference between Records Management and Compliance in Information Governance. **[6 marks]**

Answer

Records Management focuses on organising, storing, and managing information throughout its lifecycle, including how data is created, used, and deleted (*3 marks*).

Compliance focuses on ensuring that information is handled according to laws, regulations, and organisational policies, including monitoring and audits (*3 marks*).

Question 7. (Information Governance)

An organisation collects and stores large amounts of structured and unstructured data from multiple sources.

Explain one challenge this creates and how Information Governance helps address it.

[6 marks]

Answer

One challenge is that large volumes of data increase complexity, cost, and risk, making it difficult to manage and control information effectively (*3 marks*). Information Governance helps by ensuring that only valuable data is retained, applying data retention policies, and removing unnecessary or duplicate data (*3 marks*).

Question 8. (Cybersecurity and hacking)

What is penetration testing and why is permission important? **[5 marks]**

Answer

Penetration testing is an authorised security test where ethical hackers attempt to find weaknesses in a system (*3 marks*). Permission is important because without it, the activity would be illegal under the Computer Misuse Act (*2 marks*).

Question 9. (Cybersecurity and hacking)

A company experiences a cyber-attack. The attacker first gathers information about the system, then identifies weaknesses, gains access, installs malware to stay in the system, and finally hides their activities.

Using your knowledge from the lecture, explain the stages of this cyber-attack and their purpose. **[10 marks]**

Answer

The attack begins with **reconnaissance**, where the attacker gathers information about the target system without being detected (2 marks). This is followed by **scanning**, where the attacker identifies vulnerabilities and possible entry points (2 marks). Next is **gaining access**, where the attacker exploits these vulnerabilities to enter the system (2 marks). After that, the attacker **maintains access** by installing malware or creating backdoors to stay in the system (2 marks). Finally, the attacker **covers their tracks** by hiding or deleting evidence to avoid detection (2 marks).

Question 10. (Cybersecurity and hacking)

A person logs into a company's computer system without permission and copies some files. Under the Computer Misuse Act, what offence has been committed and what is the possible penalty? [6 marks]

Answer

This is an offence of unauthorised access to computer material (2 marks). The person accessed the system without permission and copied data. The penalty can include imprisonment (up to 2 years), a fine, or both (4 marks).

Question 11. (Computers at the workplace)

Give three reasons why organisations monitor employees in the workplace. For each reason, state one potential benefit of that monitoring.
(Max 100 words) [9 marks]

Answer

Organisations monitor employees to prevent loss of productivity, which helps ensure employees focus on their work and improves efficiency (3 marks). Monitoring is also used to protect organisational assets, helping prevent misuse of systems or data (3

marks). Another reason is to reduce legal risks, as monitoring can help detect inappropriate behaviour and ensure compliance with policies (3 *marks*).

Question 12. (Computers at the workplace)

Describe the steps an organisation follows when dealing with an employee suspected of gross misconduct. [8 marks]

Answer

An employee may be suspended on full pay during the investigation (up to five working days) (2 *marks*). The issue is then investigated (2 *marks*). A formal disciplinary process is followed (2 *marks*). If gross misconduct is proven, this may lead to summary dismissal with no notice (2 *marks*).
